



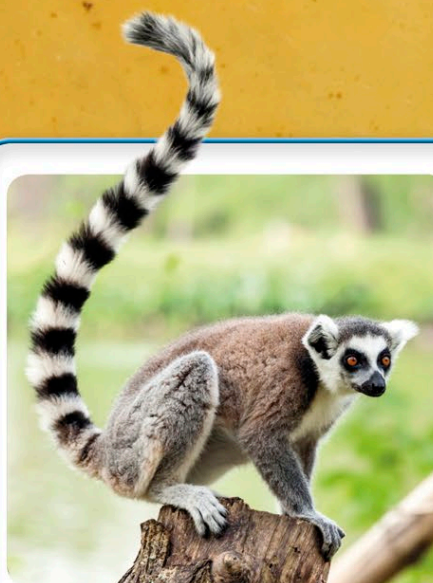
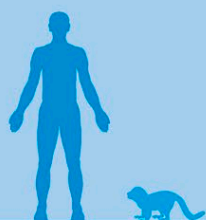
A long tail helped *Darwinius* keep its balance as it moved among the trees.



Flexible finger joints

AT A GLANCE

- **YEAR OF DISCOVERY** 1983
- **PLACE** Messel Pit, Germany
- **STUDIED BY** Jens L. Franzen and team
- **LIVED** 47 MYA



LEMUR COUSIN

When paleontologists studied the bones of the tree-dwelling *Darwinius*, they discovered it was part of a group of primates that includes modern-day lemurs and lorises and shares a common ancestor with the monkeys and great apes.